



University of Essex

Your studies

Department of Psychology

Undergraduate Student Handbook 2025-26



Welcome

A very warm welcome! We are delighted that you chose to study Psychology with us here at the University of Essex. Whether you are joining us in your first year or are returning to us after the summer vacation, we are thrilled to have you (back). While for many of our staff it has been a little while since they studied for their undergraduate degree, all of us can still remember what it felt like at the time. There are challenges and opportunities and sometimes we just don't know where to start (or end). This is why we are here to guide you through the academic year. We also all know how important it is to make connections. Not everyone needs to become your new best friend (but many of us have made friends for life while studying!) – sometimes it is just nice to know the name of the other person and have a quick chat between lectures. We try to put on lots of activities throughout the year to facilitate this process, but we need your help. Make sure you let us know what you are hoping to get out of the (social) experience. The Department provides a vibrant and dynamic place in which to study but often students tell us that they didn't really make use of the offers until their 3rd year. If you are studying with us in year 1 or 2, make sure not to repeat the same mistakes! We encourage you to make full use of our excellent facilities, including our research and computing laboratories. The more you immerse yourself in departmental and university life, the more you will get out of your experience. We are here to support you along the way.

You will be taught by experts in the different fields of Psychology and you will receive up-to-date courses taught by well-qualified, highly-knowledgeable and highly-motivated staff. We are sure that you will find your studies both challenging and rewarding, that is part of University life. If we're doing something good, let us know. But if things could be improved, let us know, too. You will be allocated a student advisor in the department, who will be there to help you get the most out of your studies, and to signpost you to other help and advice as required. Make sure you let them know how you are doing. As student members of the department, you will play a vital role in contributing to our thriving Psychology community. You can do this through participation in our research experience scheme (RES) or our social media,

activities and events experience scheme (SHOUTS). Keep an eye and ear out for more information and how to contribute. Our community is shaped by you!

You have chosen a wonderful place to study, both in terms of research and education. Psychology at Essex was ranked 18th out of 93 UK psychology departments for the overall quality of our research power in the latest Research Excellence Framework report (REF2021). In the 2025 National Student Survey, 92% of students said that our staff were good at explaining things, and 89% said they felt supported by staff. Let's work together to make Psychology at Essex even more successful. Understanding our place in the world is the department's mission and the study of human behaviour has never been more relevant than now! Enjoy being part of this community and don't be shy to contribute. Our biggest goal is for you to experience a world-class education while enjoying your time at Essex!

Dr Gethin Hughes, Head of Department, Department of Psychology

Dr Veronica Lamarche, Director of Education



Contents

Welcome	1
Introduction.....	1
Practicalities and getting started	2
Registration (new students)	2
Registration (returning students).....	2
Right to study	3
Students with sponsored immigration permission.....	3
Choosing your modules	3
Explore your campus	4
Get connected	4
Your IT account	4
Campus wifi.....	4
Essex apps.....	4
MyEssex.....	4
Find Your Way.....	4
Working while studying	5
Your personal belongings	5
The Essex Experience	6
Embracing our values	6
Equality, diversity and inclusion	6
Student communities.....	7
Environmental Sustainability for All.....	7
Essex Sport	8
Students' Union	8
Get involved!	8
Chart My Path	9
Essex spirit, social media and what's on?	9
About the Department of Psychology	10
Meet the team	10
Teaching staff and support.....	10
Student Support Co-ordinator & Disability Adviser	10
Module Coordinators.....	11
Your Student Advisor	11
Your Peer Mentor	11
Become a Mentor	11
Staff research interests	11

Departmental/school resources and facilities	12
The Laboratories	12
SmartHub Booking System	12
The Psychometric Store	13
Software	13
Printing, photocopying and scanning	13
Noticeboards	13
Departmental/school prizes.....	14
Dean's List for Excellence	14
Communications	14
Social media.....	15
The use of personal devices	15
Learning and teaching.....	16
The academic year.....	16
My course.....	17
British Psychological Society	17
Credits	17
Learning outcomes.....	17
Grade boundaries	17
Module enrolment	18
Changing modules	18
Module Coordinators.....	19
Study and Wellbeing Intervention Policy and Procedure.....	19
Employability modules	19
Identifying your skills	20
Study Abroad	21
Work placements	22
DBS checks for placements.....	23
Safeguarding training	23
Module materials	23
Teaching timetable	23
Reading weeks.....	24
Recording your attendance	24
Making changes to your study	25
Changing your course	25
Thinking of leaving or taking a break?	25
Library and Cultural Services	26
Library Services.....	26

Publish with the Essex Student Journal	27
Lakeside Theatre	27
Academic skills support.....	28
Departmental support.....	29
Proofreading services	29
Language classes	29
Academic English support classes	29
General English classes for beginner/intermediate/advanced learners (GEC)	29
Learning a language	30
Assessment and Academic Integrity	31
Rules of Assessment	31
Core, compulsory and optional modules.....	32
Academic integrity and academic offences.....	32
Using AI for Assessments	32
Methods of assessment in the Department of Psychology	33
Coursework	33
Preparation of assignments	34
Samples of coursework.....	34
Referencing in coursework.....	34
Submission of coursework	34
Problems with FASER.....	35
Late submission of coursework.....	35
Return of coursework	35
Ethics in research.....	36
Examinations.....	37
Exam timetable.....	37
Attending an in-person exam	38
Calculators in examinations	39
Open and closed-book exams	39
Sample and past papers	39
Revision classes	39
Exam stress.....	39
Access to your exam script	39
Moderation and marking	40
Marking.....	40
Moderation and double marking.....	40
External Examiners	40
Re-marking of coursework	40

Appeals	41
Feedback.....	41
The Board of Examiners	41
Publication of results	42
Reassessment	42
Resit exams and coursework	43
Exit awards.....	43
Extenuating circumstances	43
Computers, learning technologies and your information	45
Computers.....	45
Using a campus computer	45
IT training and help	45
Learning technologies and systems.....	45
Learner Engagement Activity Portal (LEAP).....	45
Moodle.....	46
FASER	46
Online reading lists.....	46
Listen Again.....	46
Zoom	47
Your information	47
Changes to your information	47
Your personal information	47
Student Voice	48
Student Representatives	48
Student Voice Groups	48
Student surveys	48
National Student Survey	48
Undergraduate Student Survey (non-final year students)	49
Student Module Feedback	49
You Matter.....	49
Student Services Hub	49
Support for students with disabilities or additional needs	50
Support for students who are pregnant.....	50
Support for students who are parents or guardians.....	50
Financial Support for students with disabilities or additional needs.....	51
Personal Emergency Evacuation Plans (PEEP).....	51
Essex Access Forum	51
Seeing a doctor	51

Counselling service	52
Digital wellbeing support	52
Student Wellbeing Support Line	52
Wellbeing Appointments for Students at Colchester, Southend and Loughton	52
UK immigration advice and guidance	53
Money management	53
Funding opportunities	53
Students' Union Advice	53
Religion, faith and beliefs	54
Harassment support	54
Health and safety on campus	54
Making a complaint	55
Student Development	56
Careers Services	56
CareerHub	56
Get experience	56
Volunteering	56
Participation in research	56
Research Experience Scheme	57
You Are Essex	58
Graduation and Awards	58
Award documents	58
Graduation ceremonies	58
References	59
Requesting references from members of staff	59
Copies of references	59
Alumni	59
What comes next?	60
Academic career advice	61
Step 1: Is an academic career right for me?	61
Step 2: Graduate study	62
Step 3: After Graduate study	62

Introduction

Your Student Handbook will tell you everything you need to know about your department or school, the University, its academic policies and procedures, and all of the resources that are available to you.

At Essex we put the success of our students at the heart of everything we do, and want to support you to achieve outstanding outcomes. We are absolutely determined to provide you with the best Essex education and student experience we can, while safeguarding your health and wellbeing.

We celebrate diversity and challenge inequality. We are a truly diverse community where differences are celebrated, and individuality is valued. Your contribution is welcomed and encouraged based on your own thoughts and experiences. As part of our community, you will have the freedom to explore, experiment, challenge your discipline and have your ideas shaped by peer and professional knowledge from all over the world. Essex is about more than just getting a degree: we have so much to offer our students.

Things might have to change and adapt over the year, so make sure that you're checking online and keeping in touch with your department or school for the latest updates. The [Student Directory](#) contains a wealth of other helpful sources of information which you may also find useful.

Practicalities and getting started

Registration (new students)

As a new student, you must complete our [registration process](#) in order to begin your studies with us. Registration is not only a formal procedure to enrol you into the University, but also connects you to vital systems which allow you to access your online Welcome and Induction information and start your studies. Because of this, you'll be asked to complete the following compulsory steps: activate your Essex IT account, provide key information about yourself as part of Online Registration (including payment of fees where required), complete an online Right to Study check and attend an in-person Right to Study check on campus, where you will collect your Student Registration Card. Once you've completed these steps, you'll be fully registered and be able to begin attending teaching and engage with your course.

You should ensure you have completed the [registration process, including payment of your fees \(where required\) by the published Latest Registration Deadline](#) for your course. If you do not do this, you may not be allowed to register and begin your course with us.

Registration (returning students)

As a returning student, you will need to ensure you complete [Online Registration and pay your fees \(if required to do so\)](#) at the start of each academic year to be able to continue your studies with us. It is essential that you complete all required steps, by the published [Latest Registration Deadline](#), otherwise you may not be allowed to continue your studies with us. This is in line with Regulations relating to Registration 5.4.

If you are a student undertaking studies with us with a form of immigration permission, in some instances you may be required to undertake an additional Right to Study check, before being permitted to re-register. This may be the case if one or more of your documents have expired, your immigration status has changed or you have changed programme and have been required to obtain a new visa. You will be contacted by our International Services Team if you need to complete an additional check.

Right to study

The University must ensure all students have the right to study at the University of Essex for the whole duration of their course. If you were born outside the UK or Republic of Ireland, your [immigration permission](#) to study in the UK will be checked via the online Right to Study system, when you first arrive on campus, and as necessary thereafter. Students have a duty to maintain valid UK immigration permission that allows study for the duration of their course, failure to do so may lead to withdrawal from the University under the [University's General Regulations](#).

Students with sponsored immigration permission

The University is a Student Sponsor with a track record of compliance and must ensure we remain compliant to retain our sponsor status. Student visa holders have [additional responsibilities](#) to the University and the Home Office. There will be conditions attached to your visa that restrict what you can do in the UK, breaking any of the conditions may mean you can't remain in the UK and complete your course. You are expected to attend your in-person teaching events and this will be monitored throughout your course. If your [attendance and engagement](#) fall below the Home Office expectations, or you are absent without permission for a period of time, we must take action, and this can include withdrawing our visa sponsorship. The International Services Team can provide [immigration information and advice](#) throughout your studies in relation to the student categories of the Immigration Rules.

Choosing your modules

You may have module options to select as part of your course structure. If you do, you must select the modules you wish to enrol on before the academic year begins. You can view and choose your specific options through the [eNROL system](#). New students can do so from the end of August and returning students can from the April preceding the next academic year. Early module enrolment ensures that timetables can be scheduled effectively. We'll talk more about how you might decide which modules to take in the [Learning and Teaching](#) section of this Handbook.

Explore your campus

There is a broad range of [facilities](#) across each of our campuses to support your experience at Essex, whether in person or virtually. For the latest information, see the updates on [services on campus](#).

Get connected

Your IT account

You will need to set up [your Essex IT account](#). This will give you access to your Essex [email](#), [Moodle](#), campus wifi, campus computers and many more digital resources. When you set up your Essex IT account, you will need to register an external email address and passphrase so that if you [forget your Essex password](#), you can also reset it using these details. If you have forgotten those, you should contact the [IT Helpdesk](#). Make sure you keep your password safe and do not share it with others.

For a quick rundown of what you need when you first start, head to the [Getting Started with IT guide](#) on the Student Directory.

Campus wifi

If you are studying on any of our campuses, connect to our wifi by finding the [eduroam network](#) on your device. Use your Essex email and password to join.

Essex apps

The University has a variety of online systems and platforms designed to enhance your learning and help make processes, such as submitting coursework, easier. We have rounded up the top platforms, portals and apps that you need to know about!

MyEssex

[MyEssex](#) is your online account and can only be accessed via an internet browser. This is different to your applicant portal – you can use MyEssex to view your timetable, update your personal details, request replacement student cards or supporting documents, monitor your course progress, let us know if you'll miss a lecture or class, contact the Student Services Hub, and much more.

Find Your Way

When on campus, we know that finding your way can be challenging to start with. Our Colchester campus in particular can be difficult to navigate with a historically complex

room numbering system! [FindYourWay](#) is our interactive campus map app designed to get you from A to B on either the Colchester or Southend campuses with quick and easy directions.

Working while studying

Many students choose to work part-time to supplement their income. Working during your course can also give you excellent skills and experience to boost your CV. Our [Career Services Team](#) can help you find part-time work. There are also many opportunities to [work in paid jobs on campus](#).

You can access recommendations on working hours, as well as guidance on rates of pay and National Insurance contributions on the [Careers Services webpages](#).

If you have a Student visa, please read our information on [working in the UK for international students](#) before you start looking for a job. Your visa type will determine whether or not you can work in the UK. If you can work, the type of work you are allowed to undertake and the number of hours you can work will be restricted.

Your personal belongings

The University does not cover costs for personal damage or loss of possessions; only in instances where the University has been negligent would a claim be viable for compensation for personal belongings. Therefore, you are strongly advised to take out personal insurance cover for your possessions. This is especially important for valuable items, such as laptops, phones and tablets.

The Essex Experience

We are proud of our inclusive and international community. Our campuses are places where every single person can feel they belong and where you can find the world in one place. We have created a [Student Charter](#) as a pledge that every student signs up to when they join us. By signing up, you promise to uphold our values and to behave in ways that strengthen and support our community. We promise to support you at every stage of your journey with us.

Embracing our values

We are different at Essex. We are brave, we are bold, and we embrace challenges and drive change. Our values are underpinned by this very culture. While we encourage you to challenge the status quo and explore the unknown, we expect that all of our students do so respectfully, intelligently and act as true ambassadors for the University. Our [Code of Student Conduct](#) outlines the rules and regulations that help us maintain our high standards of behaviour.

Equality, diversity and inclusion

The University recognises the value of diversity and is committed to providing equal opportunities for our whole community. Our students and staff are treated with dignity and respect, and solely on the basis of their merits, abilities and potential, while still having the relevant impact and implications associated with race, ethnic or national origin, gender, gender identity, sexual orientation, disability, age, socio-economic background, family circumstances, religious or political beliefs and affiliations, or any other identity-forming characteristics, taken into consideration as necessary to ensure equal opportunity.

The University is committed to a programme of action to ensure that this [policy](#) is fully effective.

The Department of Psychology has achieved a Silver Departmental Athena SWAN Award and there is a dedicated Equality, Diversity and Inclusivity (EDI) committee. Everyone is welcome to join our monthly EDI lunches and contribute to discussions on equality and inclusivity. Feedback on these issues is also very welcome (e.g. through the Student Voice groups).

Student communities

We pride ourselves on being a welcoming and inclusive community. We recognise the value of diversity and are committed to equality of opportunity within the University.

We offer a wide range of support to individuals and groups of student members – [our student communities](#) – who may have specific requirements, interests or responsibilities to help fulfil your potential. Whether you are an international student, a mature student, a Black, Asian or Minority Ethnic (BAME) student, or have any other requirements or needs, we want to welcome you with open arms. The University is committed to a programme of action to ensure that this [policy](#) is fully effective.

Environmental Sustainability for All

The University of Essex is committed to reducing its environmental impact by reaching net zero carbon emissions by 2035. The Sustainability team works on a range of projects such as carbon reduction, reuse and recycling, and sustainable education. During your time at Essex there are extracurricular opportunities for you to learn more about sustainable development and equip you with the skills and knowledge that will help you in your future choices – whether that's further study or the start of your career. Be sure to check your programme modules if you're keen to take environmentally focused course options. You can access extra-curricular activities through Chart My Path and the vTeam, plus you can join the Students for Sustainability Group. Your participation in all additional events is recorded on [Higher Education Achievement Record](#) (HEAR), your online CV. There are easy everyday habits to help you do your bit too – bring your own takeaway cup to cafes on campus for a discount and remember your bottle to refill at one of our many water coolers. There are lots of recycling bins across our campuses to encourage mindfulness when disposing of your waste. If you're living on campus, be sure to switch off lights and chargers when not in use, and keep windows closed in colder months when the heating is on. For any more information, head to the sustainability pages on the Essex website. If you have questions or an idea for a sustainability event or project of your own contact the Sustainability team: sustainability@essex.ac.uk. Follow us on Instagram: [@uoe_susandgrounds](#) and [LinkedIn](#).

Essex Sport

Learning doesn't just happen in the classroom. Keeping active during your studies is a great way to meet new people, help relieve stress, maintain good physical and mental wellbeing, increase productivity, and improve your employability.

Join [Essex Sport](#) and be part of something bigger. We're a community of like-minded individuals who are dedicated to enriching your experience at University of Essex. By fuelling your passion for all things active we help you make new friends, find new interests and be the best you. Whatever your sport, whatever your level, from fan to [professional athlete](#), we've got a place for you.

Visit the [Essex Sport](#) website or [download the app](#) to discover all the ways you can keep active during your time at Essex. In order to ensure the welfare of our community there may be changes to opening hours or what's available, so do check on the website and our [Facebook](#), [Instagram](#), [X \(formerly Twitter\)](#) for the latest information.

Students' Union

We're famous for our [Students' Union at Essex](#), and for good reason. Here you are not just a member of a normal Students' Union, you are part of a family. They are here from the day you arrive to the moment you graduate to support you in any way they can.

The Students' Union is run by students for students, and you have the ability to shape what they do. From deciding who leads the SU, to shaping your own experiences at Essex, they are here to represent your views and work with you to make amazing things happen.

Not to mention you'll find everything from bars, nightclubs, shops and coffee shops, run by the SU at our [Colchester](#) campus, as well as bespoke support for SU members in [Southend](#) and [Loughton](#).

Get involved!

There are opportunities to join [Sports Clubs](#), and get involved with competitive sports in our [BUCS teams](#).

We have over 100 [Societies](#) where you can meet people with similar interests, challenge yourself with something new or if you can't find what you are looking for- [Start your own.](#)

We also train, recruit and support hundreds of student reps each year. These reps gather feedback to share student viewpoints on academic experiences. You can find out more about student reps including how to sign up and getting trained [here](#).

Our [SU Advice](#) team are here to offer confidential, independent and impartial advice on a range of issues

We also have our very own lettings agency ([SUHomes](#)), to offer help and support to students to find off campus accommodation.

Chart My Path

Use Chart My Path to discover over 150 extracurricular activities offered at Essex, and get recommendations personalised to you. Log into [GradIntelligence](#) to get started.

Essex spirit, social media and what's on?

Keep up to date with important news, events and offers from across the University with our Essex spirit newsletter, delivered directly to your Essex email address.

Follow us on social:



[/uniofessex](#)



[/uniessex](#)



[/Uni_of_Essex](#)



[/@uniofessex](#)



[/university-of-essex](#)



[/uniessex](#)

Our [Events calendar](#) brings together all the events happening across our three campuses, so you can make the most of your time at Essex.

About the Department of Psychology

Meet the team

A full list of all staff can be found on [our website](#).

Teaching staff and support

All teaching staff hold regular weekly academic drop-in hours during term time. This is a time when you can meet with your teaching teams and/or student advisor to ask about anything to do with your modules, from difficulties you might be having with your seminar readings, to discussions about feedback on your coursework, to pastoral support needs.

Please note that academic staff do not hold regular academic support hours out of term, or during the vacations, and may, on occasions, be away from the University on research trips and visits. Therefore, if you need to get in touch with them during the vacation periods, you should email them in the first instance. If academic staff are unavailable, please reach out to the administration team.

We have also listed some other key staff roles and how these individuals will be able to support you.

Student Support Co-ordinator & Disability Adviser

The Departmental Student Support Co-ordinator and Disability Adviser for Psychology is Dr Tracy Robinson. You can contact Dr Tracy Robinson on tracy@essex.ac.uk. Dr Robinson is a direct link for you between the Student Services Hub and your department. They can help make sure that the Disability Service know about any adjustments you need.

The Administration Team

The best way to contact us is by email using psyugadmin@essex.ac.uk. This will be delivered to our Senior Student Administrators. It is helpful if you can include your registration number and year group in your email. We always try to reply within two working days. If you would prefer to talk, you can drop into the office (3.702) and we can also organise meetings via Zoom or a phone call. We are always happy to talk to you and will arrange a call at a mutually convenient time.

The Technical Services Team

The Technical Services office is open from 09:30am-4:30pm, Monday to Friday for equipment collection, returns and door key loans only. For all other enquires and support email psysupport@essex.ac.uk.

Module Coordinators

There are dedicated Module Coordinators to support students for each module. The module coordinator for each module can be found on Moodle. If you have a specific study question please contact the relevant module tutor. Contact details can be found in the [module directory](#).

Your Student Advisor

All undergraduate students are assigned a dedicated Student Advisor who will meet you soon after you arrive, and regularly throughout your course. Your Student Advisor will be a member of academic staff and is someone you talk to about your course or any difficulties that may encounter. They can recommend and direct you to other support services that might be able to further help and support you. You can find out who your Student Advisor is through [MyEssex](#) or [Moodle](#).

If you have a disability, long term medical condition and/or Specific Learning Difference and have not registered with Student Wellbeing & Inclusivity Service, to discuss your support needs, please email include@essex.ac.uk.

Your Peer Mentor

Peer Mentors are available on request. Please contact the Psychology Administration team for more information.

Become a Mentor

If you are in your second or final-year and are interested in becoming a Peer Mentor, a call for mentor applications is usually circulated in the Spring term. If you have any questions in the meantime, you can contact your [Peer Mentor Coordinator](#) for further details.

Staff research interests

You can find out more about the areas of Research the Department covers on our [research webpage](#).

Departmental/school resources and facilities

A wide range of facilities and resources are available for all students to access and use as part of their study at Essex. Each department and school also has a selection for the exclusive use of their students. Below is a summary of the facilities and resources that are likely to be most useful to you.

The Laboratories

The Department has excellent learning resources and facilities for our students. We have custom-built laboratories and first-class equipment. The laboratories are on Floors 1 and 2 of the Psychology Department. They house a large number of computers, each supporting statistics processing packages, standard Microsoft Office applications and specialist psychology experiment building tools.

For the convenience of others and yourself please be aware that there are a few guidelines relating to Lab use:

- No food, drink or chewing gum.
- Please do not prop the door open.
- Save your work regularly onto your M drive. (File saved to the desktop or hard drive will be removed)
- Do not install anything onto any computer.
- Please report any faults to the Technicians (room 2.712).

SmartHub Booking System

The Department operates an online booking system called SmartHub. SmartHub is our main source for staff and students to book labs, psychometric tests and small equipment to support research. Small items of equipment are available to loan for a maximum of two weeks.

To register an account to use the SmartHub system, please go to [the website](#) and click on 'Account Registration'. Once complete, your registration will be directed through to the technical team to ensure users have the right level of access. Once approved, you will receive an email notification and be able to start using the system. Please allow one full working day for the approval.

A user guide is available for getting started with the SmartHub system. This can be requested from the technical team.

The Psychometric Store

The Psychometric Store is in Room 2.711A on Floor 2 of the Psychology building and is administered by the Technical Services team in Room 2.712. You may borrow items from the Psychometric Store only with permission from your lab tutor or project supervisor. The store contains a wide range of equipment, headphones, questionnaires and psychometric tests, voice recorders and stop watches.

Most items in the store are available on a two-week loan basis. Requests to renew the loan period must be made by contacting the Technical Services team. Please e-mail the team (psysupport@essex.ac.uk) at least five working days before you require extending a loan in case the item needs to be recalled. Requests for loan of equipment, laptops, IT and AV equipment should be addressed directly to the Technicians in room 2.712 (psysupport@essex.ac.uk).

Software

The University provides a number of software applications that are free to use whilst you are a student (Microsoft Office, SPSS, Matlab etc.) A full list of applications can be found and installed from the [central software hub](#).

Printing, photocopying and scanning

All students can [print, copy and scan for free at Essex](#) subject to our fair use policy. You can print from a campus PC or from your personal device using our mobile print service. Campus printers can be found in or near to study spaces where there are computers. Find out how to print and how to top up your printer credit on the [Student Directory](#).

Please note that there are strict laws about [copyright](#) infringement; more information can be found on the [Library website](#) which explains what and how much you are permitted to copy. Usage is monitored and subject to a fair use policy.

Noticeboards

Every department and school has their own noticeboard providing information on staff, courses and classes, updates, careers, events and opportunities. The main

Psychology noticeboards can be found outside of room 3.702 next to the entrance from Square 1.

Departmental/school prizes

Each year we are pleased to award prizes signifying excellence. The following prizes are available for award to undergraduate students:

- **First Year Psychology Prize** for Best Overall Year mark
- **A.T Welford Memorial Prize** for the Best Research Skills
- **Second Year Psychology Prize** for Best Overall Year mark
- **Ray Meddis Prize** for Research Project with the highest mark,
- **Michael Lodge Memorial Prize** for the Best Overall Degree mark
- **The British Psychological Society Award** for Best overall degree mark across our accredited courses.
- **Margaret Bell Prize** for Outstanding contribution to the Department.

Dean's List for Excellence

The Dean's List for Excellence is an annual list of students within each Faculty who have achieved a high level of performance in a non-Final Year of degree level study.

To be included on the Dean's List for Excellence, you must have achieved either:

- (a) A Year Mark of 70 or above, or
- (b) 60 Credits at 70 or above with a Year Mark of 68 or 69.

Communications

The University will predominantly use email for routine communication between staff and students. Your Essex email address will have been added to the relevant email groups specific to your department or school, course and modules to ensure that you receive the essential information relevant to you. It is recommended that you check your Essex email each day to ensure you do not miss any important updates to classes and assessment.

You will also automatically be subscribed to a small number of opt-out lists, again, based on your course. You can always [opt in or out](#) of these communications online.

Social media

The Department has active social media profiles which keep students up to date with upcoming events and opportunities. These can be found here:



/PsychologyatEssex



/EssexPsychology



/essexpsychology/

The use of personal devices

You can use laptops and tablet PCs during teaching classes for purposes related to the class you are attending. You should refrain from using your mobile phone during all teaching events, except in cases where a lecturer uses a programme which requires these devices to be switched on for participation.

Learning and teaching

The University is committed to providing equal opportunities for all our students regardless of where or how you study. Our diverse student population is considered when developing the resources, services and facilities on and off campus, when we create our courses, write publications and course materials, and set our policies and regulations.

The academic year

The academic year uses a week numbering system that covers the 52 weeks of a calendar year but corresponds to typical term dates. So, the start of the academic year is week 1, which is Welcome week, with teaching commencing in week 2.

Term	Week numbers
Autumn	2-11
Spring	16-25
Summer	30-39

You can view the University's week numbers with the equivalent dates in the week by week [calendar](#). The University's [key dates](#) include an overview of the start and end of each term and exam periods.

Some courses have slightly different term dates. However, you will find that all activities and events make reference to the standard academic year terms and schedule noted above.

You are expected to be available during term time to attend teaching events, unless otherwise advised by your department or school. Please note that this may include timetabled sessions throughout your summer term. For international students, this period continues to be monitored by the home office and failure to engage with timetabled events could result in visa non-compliance.

My course

Each course at the University has its own syllabus, full details of which, including the aims and learning outcomes of your course, can be found in the University's [Programme Specifications Catalogue](#).

Your own course structure, including your specific programme specification, can be found in the MyStudy section of your [MyEssex](#) homepage.

British Psychological Society

Many of our degrees are accredited by BPS. This means they are recognised by British Psychological Society (BPS) for the purposes of Graduate Membership and towards the Graduate Basis for Chartered Membership. Accreditation gives graduates the opportunity to gain Graduate and/or Chartered Membership (GBC) of the Society. GBC is an entry requirement for all postgraduate training programmes leading to chartered status.

In order to gain a degree that confers the British Psychological Society's Graduate Basis for Chartering (GBC) status, you must obtain an overall classification of at least lower second-class honours (2.2) and you must obtain a pass in the PS300 project module. Full details about graduate membership can be found on the BPS [website](#).

Credits

Your course will be made up of a certain number of credits. Generally, undergraduate degree courses are made up of 360 credits. This is divided into 120 credits per year of study, with credits allocated to each module that you take.

Learning outcomes

Each course has learning outcomes which need to be met in order to progress. Course learning outcomes are categorised into knowledge, intellectual, practical and key skills, and are also defined more specifically at a modular level. Having this information means that you can measure your progress against the outcomes, for example when reviewing coursework feedback.

Grade boundaries

Marks for undergraduate modules at NQF Level 5 and above fall into one of the classifications set out in the table below. Honours degrees are usually awarded under

these classifications too. The method for calculating your final award classification will take into account module marks and any other requirements - full details are set out in the [Rules of Assessment](#).

Degree mark	Class
70 and over	Class 1
60 - 69	Class 2.1
50 - 59	Class 2.2
40 - 49	Class 3
39 and under	Fail

Module enrolment

Most modules taught reflect the individual research interests of members of our academic staff. New modules are regularly explored, researched and developed to expand our transformative educational offering at Essex.

The University provides [further guidance](#) on choosing modules, and meetings for first and second-year students will be held by your department or school where students can discuss their choices with their Student Advisor. Your preferred choices must be submitted prior to the start of term through the [eNROL](#) system.

A full list of modules available can be found on this [webpage](#).

Changing modules

In instances where you need to make a change to your module choice, you may do so up until the second week of the Autumn Term. If you wish to change an optional module after the deadline, you should seek advice from the Department or School Office that runs the particular module that you may wish to change to.

Late changes may be permitted but will be subject to the approval of the department or school that runs the module and, in some cases, the relevant Dean. Late changes of modules that run for one term or less will not usually be permitted. Students may not change modules that are core or compulsory for the course for which they are registered.

Module Coordinators

Module Coordinators are responsible for individual modules. They design, teach and examine them. They monitor student progress and can also talk to students about any related academic issues.

Study and Wellbeing Intervention Policy and Procedure

[The Study and Wellbeing Intervention Policy and Procedure](#) provides a framework to support students during their studies when it appears that their health and wellbeing is either disrupting or having a detrimental impact on themselves or on people around them. The policy applies to all students and aims to ensure students are offered appropriate intervention and support to succeed academically, and provides a framework to support students during their studies when it appears that their health and wellbeing is either disrupting or having a detrimental impact on themselves or on people around them. The policy applies to all students and will aim to ensure students are offered appropriate intervention and support to succeed academically.

Employability modules

Each year of your degree includes a module aimed at providing you with the knowledge and confidence you need to pursue your chosen career and goals.

Modules comprise of timetabled sessions run collaboratively by staff from the Department of Psychology and the Careers team in Student Development, and sessions with guest speakers.

The modules:

- provide opportunities to reflect upon your strengths and weaknesses and decide upon your personal goals and career aspirations.
- help you identify the steps required to reach those goals.
- introduce opportunities and resources to achieve your goals.

[Year One](#)

[Year Two](#)

[Final Year](#)

Identifying your skills

Through engaging with the curriculum and different experiences on offer in your core modules, you will be developing and utilising a variety of transferable skills and attributes. These are skills that are useful in a broad variety of careers as well as everyday life, such as analytical reasoning, communicating about scientific evidence, and being a member of a team. You will have the opportunity to work with academic staff to identify these and develop them in ways that will enhance your learning experience and support your future study and career aspirations. Below is a summary of main skills you are developing during your Psychology studies. You can also use the description of these skills for job applications.

Discovery - How I explore, plan, understand, evidence, and apply

- I understand scientific theories and can use them to solve a broad range of problems
- I also use ethical reasoning to solve problems and reach decisions
- I think critically about theories and evidence and can develop new ideas
- I use scientific methods to produce evidence, analyse data, and understand the findings
- I can self-regulate my learning and working

Engagement - How I communicate and connect for myself and with others

- I can create informative texts based on psychological theory and evidence
- I can present scientific information to non-scientific audiences
- I understand other people and human behaviour
- I can work as part of a team
- I can work as leader of a team

Identity - Who I am, what motivates me, and how I understand the world around me

- I am aware of my competencies and confident in my skills

- I take responsibility for my own skill development
- I can manage stress
- I have empathy and the skills to support others
- I appreciate diversity and cultural differences

Expertise - What I know and learn across study, work, and other interests

- I have knowledge of psychological theories and can critically evaluate them
- I know about and can use psychological methods
- I have computer literacy in psychology (e.g., use of statistics programmes)
- I can plan and conduct psychological projects
- I have knowledge of techniques to solve problems in practice

Study Abroad

[Essex Abroad](#) provides you with the opportunity to have an international experience during your time at Essex to enhance employability, gain valuable transferable skills and develop as individuals. You can study, volunteer, intern or complete research abroad as part of our programmes. Many courses can be taken as a four-year variant to include a year studying abroad at one of our partner universities across the world, and some courses have the option to study for a term abroad as part of a three-year degree. You can [find out more about applying](#) and what you'll need to consider if you're interested in a term or year studying abroad. For information regarding your funding during a study abroad, you should liaise with the Funding Team – askthehub@essex.ac.uk. Students with disabilities should also liaise with the Student Wellbeing and Inclusivity Service – include@essex.ac.uk.

As well as studying abroad, we have a wide range of [summer programmes](#) available including volunteering programmes, international internships and research abroad opportunities which are open to all Essex students. These programmes vary in duration, location and cost and can be a great addition (or alternative!) to studying abroad.

The University of Essex is a founding member of the YUFE Alliance. YUFE (Young Universities for the Future of Europe) is a collaboration of 10 different European institutions, providing you with the opportunity to study across multiple partners virtually or physically; as part of your degree or in addition to it. YUFE aims to be the leading model of a young, student-centred, non-elitist, open and inclusive European University.

As a University of Essex student, you can obtain an international experience through YUFE, taking anything from academic to language courses, or even entrepreneurship courses; allowing you to go the extra mile and stand out from the crowd. Find out more about YUFE and how to apply on our dedicated section on the [Essex Abroad YUFE webpage](#) and through the [YUFE Virtual Campus](#).

Work placements

There are a variety of opportunities to undertake work-based learning and placements either during, or as part of your studies. Many courses may also be taken as a four-year variant to include a placement year. If undertaking a placement year, it is your responsibility to find a work placement, however, the Industry Engagement and Placements Team can help prepare and support you and will advertise relevant placements. If you are interested in undertaking a placement year, or other work-based opportunities that may be available to you and your course, contact the [Industry Engagement and Placements team](#). If you have a Student visa, please be aware that the Immigration Rules restrict the length of placements and the type of work you can do.

Upon successfully securing a placement you need to inform the Industry Engagement and Placements team by contacting placements@essex.ac.uk. This is required to begin the placement approval process. Please note without approval from the Industry Engagement and Placement team you will be unauthorised to commence a placement.

For extracurricular opportunities, [Careers Services](#) are here to help. Use [Chart My Path](#) to find your personalised recommendations at Essex, and check out [CareerHub](#) for part-time jobs, internships and career development support.

The Department of Psychology gives students the opportunity to work alongside academics on an ongoing research project in our [Research Experience Scheme](#). Placements last for one term, and you'll volunteer for five hours per week, helping a researcher with tasks including library research, construction of materials for experiments, experiment design, and the collection, entry, organisation and analysis of data. The scheme is open to undergraduate and taught postgraduate students.

DBS checks for placements

Some placements may require a DBS check where you are engaging in regulated activity with vulnerable groups. This may include placements that are core, compulsory or optional, depending on the relevant module. Some activities may be carried out on an ad hoc basis for research purposes only, which are not required to meet the learning outcomes of the module or course, but will help inform your learning. More information about the DBS check process can be found on the [University's DBS webpages](#).

Safeguarding training

Prior to going out on placement students who are working with children or adults at risk should be aware of their safeguarding responsibilities. The University offers a general [introduction to safeguarding Moodle module](#) which you are encouraged to complete at the same time as your DBS check. This training is additional to the mandatory safeguarding training that may be offered by your department/school and/or the placement provider.

Module materials

Online reading lists for your modules can be found via the module Moodle page alongside other information and module materials.

Teaching timetable

Every student has a [personal timetable](#) published at the start of term which shows when and where your teaching is taking place, and Zoom links if teaching online. You can access your timetable on most mobile devices, including smart phones and tablets. You will need to have registered and activated your University of Essex log-in

and selected all of your modules (if applicable) before you will be able to access your teaching timetable.

If you wish to report a timetable clash or request a class change, you should do so via the [online timetable](#).

During Welcome Week (week 1) you may find that your timetable is blank as teaching normally commences week 2. **Please be aware that there may be changes to the location of teaching during the year, so regularly check your personal [online timetable and Essex email](#) for up to date teaching information.**

Information about teaching timetables, including requesting a class change, reporting a timetable issue and accessing your individual timetable can be found on the [University's website](#).

Reading weeks

The Department has two reading weeks. These are in weeks 8 and 19, which are for students in Year One only.

Recording your attendance

We monitor your attendance at teaching sessions on campus using your [student card](#) and an electronic system of card readers. You must tap-in at a reader within 15 minutes of the teaching session start time for your attendance to be recorded accurately. Your attendance at online teaching sessions is monitored by reviewing your logins to sessions on Zoom. Once again you must log in within 15 minutes of the event start time for your attendance to be recorded. You are expected to attend all of your mandatory sessions on [your individual timetable](#) and [report an absence](#) if you are unable to do so. If you have a Student visa, you must attend all your timetabled teaching events in-person, where this is available. Attendance at a teaching event via Zoom where the session was also delivered in-person will count as failure to attend. If you fall below the Home Office expectations we **must** take action, and this can include withdrawing our visa sponsorship.

It is your responsibility to remember your student registration card and to tap-in correctly. [Lost or faulty cards](#) can be replaced at the Student Services Hub.

Please contact your Student Advisor, department/school staff or the [Student Services Hub](#) for advice and support, particularly if you are going to be absent for several weeks.

Making changes to your study

Changing your course

If you are thinking about changing course, you will need to do so by a [certain date](#) and should first speak to your department or school, and Student Advisor. They will be able to provide advice about the things you should consider before changing your course. If you are thinking of undertaking a placement year or year abroad, you should check the requirements for these programmes by contacting the [Industry and Placements Team](#) or [Essex Abroad Team](#).

Student visa holders may not be able to change their course without first obtaining a new visa, from overseas, if eligible. You can find information on the potential visa implications of a change in course on our [immigration webpages](#). If you have any further questions, you should contact the [International Services Team](#).

Thinking of leaving or taking a break?

You may experience doubts at some point during your studies. If you're thinking about leaving Essex, we're here to support you and give you the advice you need to help you make an informed choice. You can contact your department or school, Student Advisor or Student Services Hub to speak in confidence about your concerns, and also the [different options available to you](#) and the impact they may have.

You can find information on the visa implications of your decision on our [immigration webpages](#). If you have any further questions, you should contact the [International Services Team](#).

You should also be aware of how your funding may be impacted if you choose to take a break. You can do this by contacting the Funding Team – askthehub@essex.ac.uk.

The Student Wellbeing and Inclusivity Service also provide free, confidential help and guidance for any concerns that you might have during your time at Essex. Contact wellbe@essex.ac.uk for advice on the support available for mental and emotional health, disability support, academic concerns, financial worries, and accommodation issues.

Library and Cultural Services

Library Services

The Library aims to provide all the resources you will need to succeed in your course, via [online reading lists](#) and access to extensive collections of books, journals and a variety of other resources, both online and on our shelves.

The Library team can help you learn how to search effectively so you can find appropriate resources for your assignments. They can also provide advice on [referencing](#), academic integrity, evaluating sources and more. Our [Skills at Library](#) guide provides a range of online support in these areas, and our [subject guides](#) provide subject-specific guidance and resource recommendations. In addition, the Library offers a programme of '[Workshops at Library](#)' sessions which cover key information and research skills, including searching for information, checking and evaluating sources, using AI ethically and referencing.

The Library is also home to a number of Special Collections which support the delivery of object-based learning across a variety of courses, and provide primary source material for research across many subject areas. We are home to two major art collections; [ESCALA](#) (the Essex Collection of Art from Latin America) and the [University Art Collection](#). Our Colchester Campus library houses [Special Collections](#), over 70 individual archives containing primary source materials and collections covering a variety of subjects and time periods. The collections provide a valuable resource for teaching, through object based learning and other sessions, and for research.

If you have any questions about library services, there are a range of ways you can [get in touch with the team](#).

At our Colchester Campus, the **Albert Sloman Library** on Square 5 has a variety of study spaces, including individual and group work areas and bookable study pods and rooms. You can borrow a laptop and study in our IT Lab and Library Learning Room, all available 24/7, just remember to bring your student ID card when you visit ([watch our video on where to find them](#)).

The Library offers a wide range of learning resources, online and in print, with a dedicated Helpdesk, live chat and the opportunity to book appointments with experienced Library staff to help you through your studies and into whatever you choose to do after graduation. The Albert Sloman Library is available for study 24 hours per day, seven days a week during term time, and the library's digital resources, including e-books, e-journals, skills guides and databases are always available via the [library website](#).

See the [Library website](#) for the latest information on all our libraries and the services available, including opening hours.

Publish with the Essex Student Journal

Publishing your writing with [the Essex Student Journal](#) provides the opportunity for you to develop your writing skills, showcase your work, and gain valuable experience in academic publishing and the peer review process. All undergraduate students can submit academic or creative writing regardless of your experience.

Our multi-disciplinary journal is run by and for students at the University, publishing the hard work of our students and giving you the ability to improve your writing through feedback from peer reviewers.

Not all universities have a Student Journal - this is a unique opportunity for you to publish a paper in your name and build your academic portfolio early in your career. We accept a wide range of submissions including creative writing, essays, case studies, research papers, dissertations, and academic blog posts.

Join our community of student writers to develop new skills and the best practices in writing. [Find out more about the Essex Student Journal](#) and embark on your academic publishing journey today. If you have any questions, get in touch with the Journal Team via journal@essex.ac.uk

Lakeside Theatre

The [Lakeside Theatre](#) provides a warm, welcoming social hub of creativity at the heart of the University to foster the living learning community.

We produce a programme of diverse, dynamic and accessible live performances of theatre, music, comedy, dance, workshops, artist development and live art for audiences on and off campus. It is a learning and social experience for students that will deliver key life skills to enable them to respond to a rapidly changing world with creativity and personal and cultural confidence. Students' wellbeing remains at the forefront of what we do which is why we provide opportunities for enjoyment, inspiration and creativity.

We believe that theatre is for everyone, you don't have to be studying drama or theatre studies to take part in or develop as an actor, producer, director, technician, or performer. That's why we have our [Homegrown Programme](#), to develop theatre makers at the University of Essex. Students, researchers, staff and alumni of the university can join the programme at any stage in their journey for support, guidance and opportunity to become a performing arts professional. Keep an eye out for our workshops and for when applications open up to our [Homegrown Season](#), where you can perform on our stage!

The theatre and technical facilities are kept up to date, for student use in education and further skill building in modern practices nationally and internationally.

Academic skills support

Skills for Success are here to support you with everything that you need to do well in your studies that is not directly related to your course content – in other words, the skills that you need to be successful.

We are committed to ensuring that every student is able to get the most out of their academic study and achieve their potential on their course, and provide a range of embedded teaching, [workshops](#) and [1:1s](#) on:

- [Academic writing](#)
- [Maths and stats](#)
- [Digital Skills](#)
- [Research](#) and [referencing](#)
- [English language](#)
- [Exam revision](#)

For more information, please contact skills@essex.ac.uk.

Departmental support

Skills and support, such as academic writing skills and numeracy, are embedded in your Psychology modules. Seminars, support classes, and workshops provide additional support and skills training. Some of these events run in tandem with the Skills for Success Team.

Proofreading services

Before considering the use of proofreading services, all students should first discuss their work with their Student Advisors. Many students seek 'proofreading' services at some point during their studies, but different types of editing can occur under this name which may not be appropriate in an academic context where work is assessed and could potentially qualify as an [academic offence](#). The University is keen to ensure as far as possible that students understand what [proofreading work should entail](#) and the acceptable boundaries to which any proofreading or editing must adhere to.

All students should ensure that any agreement entered into with a proofreader conforms to the [University's policy and guidance on proofreading](#).

Language classes

Academic English support classes

Skills for Success runs a range of [Academic English support classes](#) throughout the year, which all new students who have English as an additional language are invited to enrol on. These classes are free, voluntary and designed to help students improve their language proficiency and maximise their existing language skills in an academic context.

Options include 8 week or 4 week modules and one-off, bookable sessions. You can register for modules via eNROL, or can contact us at any time at skills@essex.ac.uk.

General English classes for beginner/intermediate/advanced learners (GEC)

The [Department of Language and Linguistics](#) offers the wider University of Essex community the chance to improve their English language skills through our [General English Classes](#). These classes are available to:

- Dependants and close family members of students and staff at the University of Essex
- International staff at Essex who may want to work on their general English and fluency skills
- International students currently studying at UEIC Kaplan
- International students currently studying at both UG and PG level at Essex who wish to develop their language skills

The classes, which take place at the Colchester Campus, will enable you to meet people from other countries and cultures and will help you develop your language skills. These classes are free and are taught at three basic levels: Beginner (A1/A2), Intermediate (B1/B2) and Advanced (C1/C2) and will focus on listening, speaking, reading and writing. Throughout the course, you will have a unique opportunity to develop your conversation skills, by reflecting on real-life examples of how language is used in context.

Learning a language

Learn a language at Essex to increase your global and cultural awareness. Language learning can give you the confidence to work and travel internationally, expand your options for studying abroad, and get a competitive edge when you're looking for a job. There are a number of ways to do it, either as extracurricular activity via [Language For All](#) or it may be possible to select a language module as part of your degree (see what [modules](#) are available or email lalteam@essex.ac.uk).

Assessment and Academic Integrity

All departments and schools at the University employ a variety of assessment methods designed to ensure that the learning outcomes of each module, and course, have been successfully met.

Rules of Assessment

The [Rules of Assessment](#) are used to calculate your results. There is a main set of rules for [Three-Year](#) and [Four-Year undergraduate courses](#), but some departments or schools also have additional variations to the rules, which must be met. These are published alongside the Rules of Assessment for your year of study.

In the Department of Psychology we do not have a variation to the Rules of Assessment:

Each module you take has a credit value which you are awarded if you successfully complete the module. You need to obtain a certain number of credits to be awarded your degree, and the Rules of Assessment and the Framework for undergraduate courses give you more information about this.

The following is only a summary of the key points. You should read the rules and make sure you understand them. If you need advice, ask your Student Advisor, departmental administrators, or [SU Advice](#).

Core, compulsory and optional modules

To understand the requirements to pass your course, you need to know the status of the modules that you are taking. You can find details of the status of your modules in Section C of your programme specification via [My Essex](#).

Core	You must take this module	You must pass this module. No failure can be permitted.
Compulsory	You must take this module	There might be limited opportunities to continue on your course/be eligible for your degree if you fail it.
Optional	You can choose which module to study	There might be limited opportunities to continue on your course/be eligible for your degree if you fail it.

Most modules in each year must be passed, with only a small number of credits, if any, being allowed to be failed across your degree. For the Honours Degree this is 30 non-core credits across the whole degree.

Academic integrity and academic offences

The University expects students to complete all assessment with honesty and integrity and to follow our [conventions for academic writing](#) (including appropriate referencing of sources) and ethical considerations. If you don't meet these expectations, then you may be charged with having committed an [academic offence](#), a matter the University takes very seriously.

It is your responsibility to make yourself aware of the regulations governing examinations and how to correctly prepare your coursework. An academic offence can take place even if you didn't mean to commit one, and examples include plagiarism, self-plagiarism, using [Artificial Intelligence](#) such as ChatGPT to write all or part of an assignment unless specifically permitted to do so, falsifying data or evidence, and communicating with another candidate in an examination.

Using AI for Assessments

AI refers to a broad range of artificial intelligence programmes available online that generate written responses to question prompts and even images. For example, you

may be familiar with programmes such as ChatGPT, Gemini, Bard, Claude, Bing or DALL-E. AI tools may seem like a convenient and efficient way to complete assessments quickly. However, there are serious limitations to these programmes that not only disadvantage students academically by robbing them of the opportunity to hone their own skills, but also put them at risk of a serious academic offense that could jeopardise their future in their course. Nonetheless, AI can also be a useful tool during your time at university, and there are many appropriate ways to use AI tools that do not violate ethical and intellectual expectations for students.

It is your responsibility to make yourself aware of the appropriate and inappropriate ways of using AI as a student. You can read more about the [University's AI policy here](#) and the departmental policy is outlined in your [assessment handbook](#).

Your lecturers may also provide you with specific guidance regarding AI for individual assessments. If you are ever in doubt, please ask your lecturers what their position is on using AI for a particular assessment, as they may have specific educational reasons for being more or less strict in their expectations depending on the aims of the assessment.

Methods of assessment in the Department of Psychology

Whether a module is core, compulsory or optional, all methods of assessment are compulsory. If you do not complete coursework or attend examinations, and do not have extenuating circumstances to support your non-submission or absence, then you are at risk of being withdrawn from the University.

Psychology modules offer a range of assessments each tailored to assessing the learning outcomes of the module, which can include exams, lab reports, essays, in class tests and oral presentations.

Coursework

Coursework is compulsory in all modules and failure to participate in coursework is interpreted as evidence of lack of academic progress. Your academic progress is monitored throughout the year. In severe cases, students with poor academic progress can be required to withdraw from the University (even before the final examinations).

Preparation of assignments

It is important that you prepare your assignments in the correct format, as advised by your module coordinator (see also [Undergraduate Assessment Guide](#)). All coursework is submitted online with a cover sheet.

Samples of coursework

Where possible, sample of coursework are provided within the module.

Referencing in coursework

Respecting authorship through good academic practice is one of the key values of higher education in the UK. Referencing is how you acknowledge all sources used within a piece of work. You must reference all work used whether cited directly (quotes), or indirectly (paraphrasing and summarising).

Referencing allows you to give credit to other's ideas, work, research, theories, concepts, outcomes and results, and demonstrates your breadth of reading and knowledge on a subject. If you do not reference properly, this could amount to [plagiarism](#), which is an [academic offence](#).

There are styles of referencing which will determine exactly how you format your reference. Your departmental referencing style is APA. You must use this referencing style. Guidance on your referencing style is available [online](#), including an [interactive referencing tutorial](#). You can also take the [Academic Integrity course](#) on Moodle.

Only Microsoft word or PDF files should be uploaded to FASER unless otherwise specified.

Submission of coursework

You should submit all coursework online via [FASER](#) – the University's online submission system. You are encouraged to log on to FASER at the start of the year so that you understand how it works before you reach your first deadline. There is a trial module and deadline available for you to use as a practice submission, as well as helpful guidance on [how to use FASER](#).

You can upload as many draft versions of your work as you like and are encouraged to use this as a safe and secure area to store your coursework. This can help to avoid the problem of your computer crashing at the last minute and your important files being

lost. In cases where multiple versions are uploaded you will **need to make any which you do NOT want to be included in the final submission a 'draft'**, otherwise the most recently uploaded file will be taken as the final version. The maximum file upload size is **50MB**.

Problems with FASER

If you have technical difficulties when submitting your coursework to FASER, you should contact the [IT Helpdesk](#). They can advise on any system or computer problems. This will count towards your claim when submitting a late coursework extenuating circumstance form should you need to. If you are confused or unsure how to upload or are having any non-technical difficulties, you should contact your Undergraduate Administrator.

Late submission of coursework

At the University of Essex we have a single policy for the [late submission of coursework in undergraduate courses](#): all coursework submitted after the deadline will receive a mark of **zero**. No extensions will be granted. The policy states that the mark of zero shall stand unless you submit satisfactory evidence of extenuating circumstances that indicate that you were unable to submit the work by the deadline but have been able to within the relevant Late Submission timeframe.

Where a student is unable to undertake the assessment by the deadline, and it is deemed impossible to consider a late submission request due to the nature of the assessment (e.g. absence from in-class tests, practical assignments and presentations), an [extenuating circumstances](#) form should be submitted which will be considered by the Board of Examiners.

Return of coursework

The Department will provide feedback and marks in 20 working days.

Your coursework marks will be returned electronically, and you will receive an e-mail when they are ready to view. Your module and assessment outlines will provide additional information regarding the format of the feedback you will receive for each assessment and how that feedback will be shared. It is university policy that students will receive feedback on all coursework.

It is important that students take every opportunity to engage with the feedback they receive because (a) you can get timely feedback that may help improve other assessments in that module or future assessments, (b) you can get a gauge as early as possible as to the quality of work that you are submitting, (c) you can seek additional feedback from the marker, if desired.

Ethics in research

All research involving human participants and animal subjects, whether undertaken by the University's staff or students, **must** undergo an [ethics review](#) by an appropriate body and ethical approval **must** be obtained before it commences. You should first read the [Guidelines for Ethical Approval of Research Involving Human Subjects](#) or [Guidelines for Ethical Approval of Research Involving Animals](#) in conjunction with the [Policy Statement on the Use of Animals in Research](#) and then submit an Ethical Approval application form via [ERAMS](#). You should be aware that ethical approval cannot be granted retrospectively so it is very important that you make your application before you start to recruit participants or collect data from them.

Further information about the research ethics process can be found on the [University's ethics review webpages](#). **Studies involving the NHS (i.e. patients, their data or samples; staff, their data or samples; sites; data extracted from or through clinical systems) and studies involving human tissue or adults lacking capacity to consent are very likely to need some kind of NHS approval, such as ethical approval, governance approval or study registration. Even 'data only' studies, which do not involve direct contact with NHS staff or patients, will often require approval of some kind. Service evaluations, audits and similar involving the NHS may not require NHS ethical review. In cases where the project has not been defined as research by the HRA, ethical approval will need to be sought through the University's ethics review processes. Health and social care research applications from students working at undergraduate level are no longer being accepted for Research Ethics Committee (REC) review; HRA and HCRW Approval; and/or Research and Development (R&D) study-wide review in Scotland and Northern Ireland. If your study involves the NHS, you should contact the REO Research Governance Team (reo-governance@essex.ac.uk) at an early stage for advice.**

Examinations

Examinations will either be in person in an invigilated setting on campus, or remote via FASER or Moodle. To find out whether your exam is in-person or remote, you can check the [module directory](#). Your personal exam timetable, when available, also has this information.

Exam timetable

The University [publishes the dates for exam periods](#) at the start of each year, including the date on which your personal exam timetable will be issued for each period. A link to your personalised exam timetable will be sent to your Essex account when it is ready to view.

Exam Period	Exam Dates	Timetable Publication Date
Study Abroad exams These exams are for incoming Essex Abroad students who are studying at Essex for the autumn term only.	▪ Modules with in-person exams (on campus): Monday 15 December 2025 - Friday 19 December 2025 ▪ Modules with remote exams (can be taken from any location with an internet connection): To be confirmed, but expected to be Friday 2 January 2025 - Saturday 10 January 2026 (including Saturday 3 January)	▪ In-person exams: Published mid-November 2025 ▪ Remote exams: Published late-November 2025

Christmas Vacation	Expected to be Friday 2 January 2026 - Saturday 10 January 2026 (including Saturday 3 January)	Published late-November 2025
Summer	Monday 11 May 2026 - Friday 5 June 2026 (including Saturday 16 May, Saturday 23 May and Saturday 30 May)	Published mid-March 2026
September Resits	Expected to be Monday 18 August 2026 - Friday 12 September 2026 (including Saturday 23 August, Saturday 30 August and Saturday 6 September)	Published late-July/early-August 2026

Attending an in-person exam

You must bring your registration card and exam entry form to any invigilated exams on campus. You may not be allowed entry without these. You will be able to download and print your exam entry form when you view your personal exam timetable.

For exams that are more than 1 hour long, you will not be allowed to enter the examination room if you arrive later than 55 minutes after the start of the exam. If your exam is 1 hour long or less, you will only be admitted up to 10 minutes after the start of the exam.

Attendance at examinations, whether in-person or remote, is compulsory and if you do not attend them and do not have [extenuating circumstances](#) then you are at risk of being withdrawn.

Calculators in examinations

If you are allowed to use a calculator in your examinations, the only models you are permitted to use in invigilated exams are the **Casio FX-83GT** or **Casio FX-85GT** series (CW, X or PLUS).

The only exception is for certain **Finance** exams that require a **financial** calculator, in which case you may use the **Hewlett Packard 12c** (all variants) or the **Texas Instruments BAI Plus** (including the BAI Plus Professional).

Open and closed-book exams

You should check the module directory to see whether your exam is open or closed-book. Your department or school will provide further guidance on how to prepare for your exams and on what materials can be taken into an open-book exam. You should also check the information published on the exam web pages.

Sample and past papers

Where possible, sample of past papers are provided within the module.

Revision classes

Revision classes can be found in your timetable if they are being held.

Exam stress

[Exams create stress](#) for most people, but there is a lot that you can do to prepare for them and help manage the levels of stress associated with exams. The University's Skills for Success Team offers a series of [Exam Workshops](#) which are run by specialist staff. These sessions cover revision planning and techniques, as well as sessions on relaxation and how to cope with stress. Staff in the [Student Services Hub](#) can also provide sessions on stress management if required.

Access to your exam script

If you want to see your script for an invigilated exam, you should make the request to the department or school responsible for the module within four weeks of the exam. The department or school should either: let you see the script in the presence of one of the staff responsible for teaching the module *or* give you a copy or summary of the examiners' comments on your performance. If you need to undertake an exam as part of reassessment on a module, your department or school will provide you with written feedback on any elements being reassessed.

Feedback on your exam script will not include a discussion of the mark. The marks will have been approved by External Examiners and ratified by the Board of Examiners.

Moderation and marking

The [University's Marking Policy](#) can be found online and includes our policy and procedure on the moderation of work.

Marking

All student work is marked in line with the University's Marking Policy. Within this policy, moderation is the default approach to assuring the quality and standards of marking, with double marking used in certain situations. Some types of assessment may be single marked, including where they contribute only a small amount of the overall module weighting. The full procedure and assessment marking requirements and detailed definitions can be found in the [Marking Policy](#).

Moderation and double marking

Moderation is a process separate from that of marking and provides assurance that assessment criteria have been applied appropriately. Moderators review a sample of the marked student work and liaise with the first markers if they believe that the marks are not at the correct level or do not reflect the assessment criteria or feedback given. In some situations, double marking is used instead of moderation. This means that two markers each mark the work and then agree a final mark for it.

External Examiners

External Examiners are experienced academics from other universities, but may also be from industry, business or the relevant profession depending on the requirements of the course. They give an impartial view of the course and independent advice to ensure that modules and courses at the University meet the academic standards expected across UK higher education. You can find more information about the role of External Examiners on our [External Examiner roles and responsibilities webpage](#).

Re-marking of coursework

You may, under certain circumstances, have the right to request a re-mark of your coursework. Should you feel that your work needs to be reviewed and potentially re-marked, you should first contact your department to advise you accordingly. The

[Marking Policy](#) sets out the grounds on which a request for re-marking can be submitted.

If a request for a re-mark is accepted, your marks are **not guaranteed** to increase, however, **the mark awarded after re-marking will override your original mark**. Therefore, please be aware that in all incidences where coursework is re-marked, it is possible that your marks could go down as well as up.

Appeals

[Appeals on academic grounds](#) can only be made following the meeting of the Board of Examiners and the publication of your results. All academic appeals should be submitted within 10 working days of the publication of your results by the Board of Examiners. You can only appeal your results on limited grounds. As such, we strongly advise all students thinking about making an appeal to contact the [SU Advice Centre](#).

Feedback

The expectation for the return of assessed work should be 20 working days. You should be told in advance, in accordance with [University policy](#), when you can expect marked work to be available for collection. If for any justifiable and unavoidable reason we are unable to meet our stated deadline for the provision of feedback, you should be informed of this and advised of the revised arrangements.

Departments may decide to provide feedback earlier than the feedback deadline of 20 working days. The 20 working days does not include Bank Holidays and any of the University's Christmas closure period (which is usually considered to be six days). Other vacation periods are included in the 20 working days as well as term-time (i.e. coursework handed in at the end of term should be returned at the start of the following term, not 20 working days into it). Working days are Monday to Friday.

If you need to undertake any reassessment on a module, your department or school will provide you with written feedback on any elements being reassessed.

The Board of Examiners

The Board of Examiners meet at the end of the Summer Term and use the Rules of Assessment to determine whether:

- you have passed the modules you have studied and can be awarded credits;

- you have met the requirements to progress to the next year of your course;
- you have met the requirements to pass your course and, where you have, the classification/citation you are eligible for.

If it is determined that you have not passed sufficient credits to progress to the next year of study, or, for final year students, to graduate, the Board of Examiners will also determine:

- what reassessment you could be offered and when you can take it¹;
- whether you must withdraw from your course, and your eligibility for an exit award.

Student visa holders can find the visa implications for each of the possible decisions that the Board of Examiners can make on our [immigration webpages](#). If you have any further questions you should contact the [International Services Team](#)

Publication of results

The publication schedule for results can be [found on the website](#). You will receive an email to your Essex email account as soon as your results are published online.

Reassessment

You may only undertake reassessment if the Board of Examiners says that you may do so.

If you must undertake compulsory reassessment, whether coursework or examination, it is really important that you do this. If you do not, it is likely that you will be unable to progress with your studies at the University. The Board of Examiners will not consider permitting you to proceed carrying or trailing fails if you have not attempted the reassessment.

Reassessed modules are normally capped at the pass mark of 40 unless you have extenuating circumstances which are accepted by the Board of Examiners.

¹ The Board of Examiners will not be aware of a student's immigration status. As a result, some reassessment options may be offered that are not compatible with individual student visa restrictions. Students should consider all options in conjunction with applicable visa restrictions.

In the Department of Psychology, reassessment strategies are set on a per-module basis. Please review the reassessment strategy in the module outline for each of your modules for more details on their reassessment strategy. If you have questions, please reach out to the module coordinator.

Student visa holders with leave expiring before their reassessment will need to know whether they are required to be in the UK before requesting further sponsorship to complete their studies.

Resit exams and coursework

[Resit exams](#) and coursework are usually scheduled to take place in late August and early September or 'out of residence' in the following academic year. A considerable amount of useful revision material for each module is available on Moodle. Students can contact staff, particularly Module Coordinators for the modules they are resitting, if they need help with revision or specific queries (do not leave this until the last minute as staff availability will be reduced throughout the summer). Staff can give individual feedback on summer exam performance, if requested.

Exit awards

If you decide to withdraw from your course before you finish, or you do not meet the requirements to be considered for your full award, you may be awarded an exit award which may be at a lower level, if appropriate.

Student visa holders should be aware that obtaining a lesser award will impact eligibility to apply for a Graduate visa after completion of studies. Further guidance about the Graduate route and eligibility criteria can be viewed on our [immigration webpages](#)

Extenuating circumstances

[Extenuating circumstances](#) are circumstances beyond your control which cause you to perform less well in your assessment than you might have expected, or in some instances, may prevent you from submitting coursework or attending an exam entirely. In general, valid extenuating circumstances will be of a medical or personal nature that affect you for any significant period of time and/or during assessment.

If you do need to make an extenuating circumstances claim, you should first read the guidance very carefully and seek advice from [SU Advice](#) or the [Student Services Hub](#). Please be prepared that you may need to include supporting evidence with your claim. Extenuating Circumstances claims must be submitted via MyEssex by the [appropriate deadline](#).

Your department or school will review your claim at an Extenuating Circumstances Committee and determine whether it will be accepted or rejected. The [Board of Examiners](#) will determine an appropriate course of action, such as permitting further reassessment opportunities for uncapped marks. Please note that the Board of Examiners cannot award extra marks even where there are serious extenuating circumstances.

Computers, learning technologies and your information

Computers

Using a campus computer

Visit an IT lab to [use a campus computer](#). Many are open until late and some are open 24/7. Some labs may be booked for teaching, so it is best to check availability first. If you prefer to be on the move, you can [loan a laptop](#) from the Library for a few hours at no cost.

IT training and help

If you need help with Word, Excel, PowerPoint, or EndNote, book on our digital skills training through [CareerHub](#). You also have unlimited, free access to [LinkedIn Learning](#), an online video training platform, using your Essex IT account. You can choose what you would like to learn and when. LinkedIn Learning is a great tool for both personal and professional development.

For IT help and support, visit the IT Services pages on the [Student Directory](#). You can also find information on free software available to students, account storage and how to print.

If you can't find what you're looking for, or if you need to talk to someone, contact the [IT Helpdesk team](#) who can assist you further.

Learning technologies and systems

Learner Engagement Activity Portal (LEAP)

[LEAP](#) is our student centred, personalised engagement tool. LEAP displays [your engagement](#) with university resources and activities. An algorithm within LEAP gives a weighting score to each activity and combines your use of these resources and activities to produce an overall engagement indicator. There are 5 engagement indicators (high, good, partial, low and very low) which will help you map and better understand your engagement pattern over time based on your class attendance, utilisation of Moodle etc. Full details on the resources included in LEAP, the engagement ratings and how LEAP uses your data can be found on the [LEAP webpage](#).

By providing you with a more holistic view of your studying experience, LEAP offers you the opportunity to take control of your own learning and make more informed choices about your studies, enabling you to:

- Reflect on your academic activities and overall engagement to make informed decisions about your academic studies
- Review the notes created in LEAP from meetings with Student Advisors or other university staff
- Check your attendance and ensure the information is correct

Student Advisors and other university staff may use the information in LEAP to:

- Suggest ways you could achieve better outcomes
- Check that all is well and offer information, advice and guidance
- Help you in areas of your studies that you find challenging

The University has a [Student Engagement Policy](#) which provides a structured approach based on support and mutual decision-making to maximise the success and achievement of every student.

Moodle

[Moodle](#) is our online learning environment. It holds key course and module materials, discussion forums, chat facilities, quizzes, surveys, glossaries and wikis released by your lecturers.

FASER

[FASER](#) is our **online coursework submission and feedback system**. Use it to check coursework deadlines, upload coursework and receive electronic feedback all in one place.

Online reading lists

Reading lists can be accessed [online](#). Use this service to find out the details of each week's reading and to access resources through the [Library](#).

Listen Again

Did you miss something? Our [Listen Again](#) digital recording service lets you listen again to lectures, so you grasp every detail. It's available in teaching rooms or lecture

theatres where you see the sign. Lecture videos are normally uploaded on Listen Again 24 hours after the lecture.

Zoom

You can use Zoom to join online lectures delivered by the University or attend online meetings and tutorials. If your lecture or class is going to be online, the link to join will be available in your individual timetable 48 hours before the class.

This [quick start guide](#) gives you an introduction to the essentials of joining and participating in a Zoom webinar or meeting.

Your information

Changes to your information

During your period of study at Essex, you may wish to be known by a preferred name or update your legal name on our student record database (ESIS) if your circumstances change. It is important you keep your information up to date including any change to your address or contact information which you can [manage and update online](#). If you have immigration permission to study with us and obtain a new passport or visa during your studies, please ensure you bring this to your [Student Services Hub](#) so a scan can be taken for University record.

Your personal information

We collect and hold lots of information about you, your course, and your progress so that we know who you are, what you're doing, and how you are getting on. This means we can support you and also improve our services to reflect the need of our students.

All information about you is kept securely, and access to your information is only given to staff who need it in order to do their job. You have a [right to ask for copies of information](#) we hold about you.

To find out more about what information we collect, what we do with it, who gets to see it, and your rights under the UK General Data Protection Regulation (UK GDPR) and the Data Protection Act 2018, read our [Privacy Notice for students](#).

Student Voice

At the University of Essex, the views, ideas and feedback of our students are at the heart of what the University does. The time students take to offer feedback is hugely appreciated and this feedback, both positive and developmental, is used to help make short and longer-term improvements, both to the experience of current students, but also for Essex students of the future. You can do this in a number of ways at Essex through your [Student Voice](#).

Student Representatives

You can [contact or volunteer](#) to be a [Student Representative](#) who represent the voice of fellow students in departmental/school Student Voice Groups (SVG) and other University level committees.

Student Voice Groups

[Student Voice Groups](#) (SVGs) are made up of [Student Representatives](#) and members of staff. SVGs typically meet once per term and provide an accessible arena for students to discuss with staff issues connected to teaching, learning and student support. They also provide an opportunity for the department or school to consult with students and receive feedback on new proposals. Such proposals are recorded in SVG logs, where specific details are requested in order to facilitate the feedback.

Student surveys

[Student satisfaction surveys](#) enable the University to gauge overall satisfaction amongst students. When the results have been reviewed and analysed, the University can then enhance your experience of learning at Essex by closing the feedback loop.

National Student Survey

The [National Student Survey \(NSS\)](#) is an independent survey commissioned by the Office for Students aimed mainly at final-year undergraduate students. The survey provides students the opportunity to provide feedback on their University course and experience. The feedback you provide will be used to help shape the future for your fellow students and published on the [Discover Uni](#) website to help prospective students make informed decisions about where and what they want to study.

Undergraduate Student Survey (non-final year students)

In addition to the NSS, aimed at final year students, the University runs an annual survey for all other undergraduate student groups. If eligible, you will be invited to participate via email.

Student Module Feedback

At the end of each term you will have the opportunity to provide feedback and comments on your modules via the University's [Student Module Feedback](#) process.

These surveys allow you to provide some information on your experience of each of the modules you have studied, to say what worked well and to give constructive feedback on how they can be further improved. This is critical for the University to understand what works well, and what could be improved, from the perspective of students. All feedback will be summarised and discussed by SVGs and will inform reports written for central University committees as part of our quality assurance processes.

If you have some feedback but don't know who to tell, email: studentvoice@essex.ac.uk

Your department or school will also welcome your feedback. They will have a range of quick feedback mechanism for you to use. Contact your departmental or school office if you are not sure what these are.

You Matter

We know university life can throw up all kinds of concerns and questions. Everyone has [mental health](#) – sometimes your mental health may be good, other times it may be not so good. It could be stress related to deadlines, general worries or concerns about friends and family members. Whatever is worrying you, if you need some information, advice or support, the University offer a wide range of services and support to help you.

Student Services Hub

If you need practical advice, a confidential conversation, or general information and guidance on University life, no matter what the issue is, the [Student Services Hub](#) can help. You can find out about health and wellbeing, accommodation, careers services,

money matters and much more. Your questions matter and you'll get answers from our team of experts.

To contact the Student Services Hub please use this link to access our web pages and talk to us on Live Chat: [Ask the Hub](#)

Support for students with disabilities or additional needs

We encourage all new students with a disability, long term medical condition, specific learning difference or mental health condition to disclose and register with the [Student Wellbeing and Inclusivity Service \(SWIS\)](#) so that we can plan how best to [support you in your studies](#).

If you are [care experienced, estranged from your family, primary carer and/or University of Sanctuary](#) student please contact the Student Wellbeing and Inclusivity Service (SWIS) for further information about support that may be available to you.

The University of Essex is committed to providing an inclusive educational learning environment for all students. The [Student Reasonable Adjustment Policy](#) provides a framework for the effective implementation of a reasonable adjustment and to ensure the legal requirements of the [Equality Act 2010](#) are met.

Support for students who are pregnant

If you are pregnant, you are protected under the [Equality Act 2010](#) and are encouraged to contact your department/school or SWIS via the [Student Services Hub](#). You can talk through a variety of issues including; arrangements for maternity-related absence, financial implications, visa implications and emotional support.

Support for students who are parents or guardians

There is a wide range of information, support and advice available for parents and guardians studying with us available on the [Student Directory](#). Please contact the [Student Services Hub](#) or your department for further guidance or to discuss your individual circumstances.

Children or young people under 18 who are not registered students are not permitted to attend any University teaching events so it is important that you make adequate childcare arrangements to enable you to attend your teaching and assessments. If you

have emergency childcare needs or other circumstances linked to caring responsibilities that affect your availability for teaching or assessment, we have support in place. It is important that you contact your department by [reporting your absence](#) as soon as possible to let them know you won't be there and to discuss your situation and any support they can offer. The University also has an [Extenuating Circumstances Policy](#) where absence relates to missed assessment.

Financial Support for students with disabilities or additional needs

UK students may be eligible for a [Disabled Students' Allowance grant](#). If you are not a UK student and you have a disability, you may be eligible for [other grants and funding](#). We would recommend that you [contact the Student Services Hub](#) to discuss all the options that may be available to you, as well as for general advice, support and information on health and wellbeing issues.

We also offer bursaries for UK students who are [Care Experienced, Estranged or have Refugee status](#).

Personal Emergency Evacuation Plans (PEEP)

If you have a permanent or temporary disability that may mean you have difficulty in evacuating one or more areas, you should arrange for a [Personal Emergency Evacuation Plan \(PEEP\)](#).

Essex Access Forum

The [Essex Access Forum](#) is a university-wide discussion and advocacy forum and consultation body working to support excellence in all aspects of physical and non-physical access at Essex (student education, staff employment and visitor experience). Membership is open to both staff and students, with and without disabilities.

Seeing a doctor

If you're studying on a course for more than six months, you're required to register with a local doctor. Our Colchester Campus has its own [health centre](#) or you can use the [NHS Choices postcode](#) finder to find your nearest doctor. If you require emergency medical or mental health services, there are a [number of options available](#) both through the NHS and also the University, regardless which campus you are studying at.

Counselling service

The University's counselling service is available to all registered students, including those who are intermitting on medical grounds. To learn more about the counselling service, visit the [counselling page](#) of the University website. You can also request counselling directly by completing this [form](#).

Digital wellbeing support

[Togetherall](#) is a digital, peer support, mental health platform where you can share your lived experiences and learn from the experiences of others in a safe and anonymised global community. You can also access a range of courses. Use your Essex email to [register on the platform](#).

The Wisdom App gives you access to 24/7 support via live chat and instant calling with counsellors. You can discover health plans, workouts, recipes, track your sleep, and listen to the 'Peace of Mind' podcast. Access these resources through the [Wisdom website](#) or download the App from the [App Store](#) or from [Google Play](#). Use the access code MHA307573. For more information on the Wisdom App, watch this [video](#).

Student Wellbeing Support Line

Open 24-hours a day, including at weekends and bank holidays. Ring **0800 028 3766** for emotional support at any time.

Wellbeing Appointments for Students at Colchester, Southend and Loughton

Our team of Wellbeing Assessors offer a welcoming and friendly space where you will be able to talk about anything that is happening in your life.

We can help guide you to develop the personal resources and skills you need to navigate the challenges and opportunities of student life.

Our support is designed to be short term and intended to guide you on your next steps. If you need longer term support, we can help to signpost you to external health/wellbeing services and partnerships.

You can make an appointment, either in person, online via Zoom or by telephone, by emailing wellbeing@essex.ac.uk or calling 01206 873133.

UK immigration advice and guidance

[Immigration advice and guidance](#) is regulated in the UK by the [Immigration Advice Authority \(IAA\)](#) and can only be given by those that are authorised and competent to do so. We publish lots of information and guidance on our website for students and you can contact one of our authorised advice services via the 'ask us a question' section for further advice about the UK's student Immigration Rules.

Money management

Financial Support Officers in our [Student Services Hub](#) and our independent [Students' Union Advice](#) can provide [money management and budgeting advice](#) and can talk through any financial issues that you may be experiencing and how best to tackle them. You can also ensure that you keep your finances on track by working through some free online money management modules offered by [Blackbullion](#).

If you get into financial difficulty, you should get help and talk to someone **as soon as possible**. The sooner your problem is identified, the sooner it can be solved. You may be eligible to [apply for financial support](#) to assist you with short-term unexpected and unforeseen costs while studying at Essex.

Funding opportunities

There are lots of funding opportunities available to UK and International students offered by the University and by external companies and organisations. This may be in the form of a student loan, a scholarship, or a bursary. You can find out more information, including what you may be eligible for on the [UG Scholarships and Funding webpage](#).

Students' Union Advice

Our [SU Advice](#) service also offers free, confidential, independent and impartial advice on many issues that might be affecting you. Our friendly, trained staff are on hand to support you throughout your time at Essex. You can speak to us about Academic processes and procedures, representation at University meetings, student UK visa extensions, housing, complaints, welfare and consumer issues.

Colchester students – suadvice@essex.ac.uk; 01206 874034

Southend students – suacsou@essex.ac.uk; 01702 328235 (term time only)

Loughton students – suaclo@essex.ac.uk; 01206 874034

We also have our very own letting agency [SU Homes](#) designed to offer help and support for students to find off campus accommodation.

Religion, faith and beliefs

We're proud of our vibrant and diverse multicultural community and welcome everyone, of all faiths and none. The calm, friendly and supportive atmosphere in our [Faith Centre](#) is a welcoming place for staff, students and the wider community to meet, interact and engage with each other.

Harassment support

We are Essex. We pride ourselves on being a [welcoming and inclusive student community](#). We offer a wide [range of support](#) to individuals and groups of student members who may have specific requirements, interests, or responsibilities – to help you fulfil your potential.

We encourage a culture of dignity and respect. We're committed to upholding an environment that's free from any form of harassment or bullying. Though rare, these incidents can occur and if they do our [Report and Support Service](#) is on hand to help.

Health and safety on campus

Our campuses are generally very [safe environments](#). We want to ensure that things stay this way. In order to achieve this, we work closely with local agencies including the police and borough councils. Take a look at our website for [general information and advice](#).

Please familiarise yourself with [fire safety and emergency evacuation procedures](#) for your accommodation, work or study location. If you have a permanent or temporary disability that may mean you have difficulty in evacuating one or more areas, you should arrange for a [Personal Emergency Evacuation Plan \(PEEP\)](#).

Please take note of our [advice on the safe use of electrical items and prohibited electrical items](#) in residential and non-residential areas.

All students residing on campus **must** complete the Moodle [Fire Safety Course for Residents training](#).

If you have any health and safety concerns or need to report an incident, please use the [University's reporting service](#) to notify us.

Making a complaint

The University is a large community engaged in many activities of both an academic and non-academic nature. From time to time, you may feel dissatisfied with some aspect of your dealings with the University and, when that happens, it is important that the issue is dealt with constructively and as quickly as possible without risk of disadvantage or recrimination.

The University aims to resolve complaints quickly and informally in accordance with the [Student concerns and complaints procedure](#) which can be found on our website.

Student Development

Careers Services

The [Career Services](#) team offer a programme of information, advice, guidance and support through events, workshops and one-to-one sessions. With teams dedicated to supporting work-based learning, placements, internships and professional development, we'll provide the information and support you need to thrive.

CareerHub

Book on to careers events and workshops, take career assessments, practice your interview skills, build your CV, and connect with employers on [CareerHub](#), the online Essex careers and jobs portal. You will find hundreds of live opportunities from part-time jobs, internships & placements to graduate vacancies on the jobs board. You can login to [CareerHub](#) with your Essex username and password.

Get experience

There are lots of ways to gain experience and develop your skills through our extracurricular offer, explore what is right for you via our Get Experience webpages

Volunteering

Join the vTeam and be the difference. There are plenty of opportunities to volunteer during your time at Essex. The vTeam, run by the Students Union, is a fantastic opportunity to meet new people, make friends, give something to the local community, and gain valuable skills.

Participation in research

In the first year and second year, undergraduate students will be required to undertake some research training (details provided in lectures). For this training, you may **EITHER** choose to write an essay on an aspect of Research Methods **OR** you may choose to participate in 8 hours of departmental research.

Final year students are not required to participate in ongoing research in the department. However, it is expected that final year (PS300) projects by participating for at least a few hours each term students should complete 5 credits (2.5 in person, and 2.5 online) of PS300 studies specifically to help fellow students' projects. By

contributing to each other's data collection, all students benefit by having more participants and therefore more scientifically rigorous projects. Through the web-based sign-up system (SONA) you will also find paid opportunities to participate in research ongoing in the department. In general, willingness to participate in research will help students gain insight into problems of method and technique and to gain valuable understanding of what can be expected from the participants you will use in your own research work.

Research Experience Scheme

The RES is aimed at students who have an interest in gaining research experience. The scheme allows students to work together with staff members on ongoing research projects and in doing so develop practical skills in conducting empirical work in Psychology and consequently expanding their repertoire of employability and personal development skills. Student and staff member participation is entirely voluntary. To find out more visit this [webpage](#).

You Are Essex

Graduation and Awards

Once the Board of Examiners has met, it can take between 7-10 working days for your results to be published. The University's [publication of results schedule](#) can be found online and you will be notified once this information is available. As soon as your results are ready, you will be sent an email and directed to a password protected web page. You will be able to see your marks obtained and any decisions that you must make in order to progress to the next stage of study.

Award documents

Award documents are issued after each year of study and upon final completion of an award. Digital copies of Award documents will be uploaded to your [GradIntelligence](#) account, which you will be able to access for free even after Graduating. You will be able to log into your account at any time in your career and access these documents.

Your full academic transcript will be available electronically via your [Higher Education Achievement Record \(HEAR\)](#). This not only showcases a full record of your academic achievements, but also any activities you have undertaken and logged through the [Big Essex Award](#), and any other awards and prizes that you may have received.

Your HEAR will be updated after the successful completion of each year of study, and a final HEAR will be issued upon conferral of your final award. If you are studying an award for which the University is currently unable to issue a HEAR, then you will receive a printed copy of your Transcript.

Upon conferral of your final award, your final HEAR and Award Certificate will be available on your [GradIntelligence](#) account within 7 working days. In addition to your digital Award Certificate, you will also receive a physical embossed and crested Award Certificate either at Graduation or posted to you. You will be contacted by the Graduation and Awards team regarding issue of your printed Award Certificate.

Graduation ceremonies

The culmination of all your hard work! [Graduation](#) ceremonies take place at our Colchester Campus in the Ivor Crewe Lecture Hall with a departmental Reception held

afterwards in the Sports Arena. All eligible students will be invited to attend a ceremony at the next available Graduation. Confirmed dates for future graduation ceremonies are [published online](#). It is essential that all students book their place at Graduation by the deadline provided.

The Graduation and Awards team will contact eligible students directly with more information, including eligibility and how and when to book their place at Graduation.

References

Requesting references from members of staff

If you require a personal reference, always ask permission from a member of staff before giving their name as a referee. You should consider from whom it is most appropriate to request a reference and who will be best equipped to evidence your character and performance in the subject.

For example, final year project supervisors, year organisers, and core course supervisors are likely to be more suitable than lecturers that have taught you on a first-year option course. Every reasonable effort will be made to meet a request for reference for a student who has undertaken study within our department. Requests received from students who have graduated from the University within the last three years will be prioritised. Requests received outside of this period may, of course, be met if a member of staff is equipped with the necessary information and is willing to provide a reference.

It is always helpful if you can provide the member of staff with details about the course or job you have applied for and, if relevant, a CV or other summary of your qualifications and experience. Please try to ask for references in good time – it is not always possible for a member of staff to write a reference immediately.

Copies of references

A copy of any reference provided will be retained within our department for no longer than three years for taught students.

Alumni

Essex is forever and although your time here will fly by, you'll be part of the Essex family for life. When you graduate, you'll get an alumni card and join a community of

over 130,000 fellow graduates around the world. We'd love to keep in touch and invite you to our alumni events, networking and volunteering opportunities, as well as offer you special alumni benefits. Want to know more? Visit [our website](#).

We will be here for you wherever life takes you next. You might know the path you wish to take, but if you need help to reach your goals, our Careers Services Team offer information, guidance and advice on your different options after graduation. We will be in touch 15 months after you graduate with reminders about the Graduate Outcomes survey which is your opportunity to tell us how you're doing and give us feedback on your university experience. Careers support is for life as an Essex graduate and we'll be with you every step of the way.

As an Essex graduate, you can take advantage of [generous discounts](#) on further [postgraduate study](#) and [postgraduate research degrees](#). Whatever you choose to do, please stay in touch. We'd love to hear where your Essex degree has taken you.

What comes next?

The world is your oyster! The options and opportunities open to you as a graduate can sometimes be overwhelming. You might know the path you wish to take, but if you need help to reach your graduate goals, our Careers Services Team offer information, guidance and advice on your different options after graduation. Whether it's discussing different career paths, bringing your CV or LinkedIn profile up to date, or prepping for that interview you have worked all year for, we offer careers support for life, so we'll always be here for you.

We know you'll go on to great things, but you can always come back! As an Essex graduate, you can take advantage of generous discounts on postgraduate qualifications and degrees if you chose to return to study at Essex as a postgraduate student.

We are proud of our world-class research at Essex and your invitation to contribute is lifelong. If you do decide to stay on for further study with us, you'll develop extensive knowledge in your chosen area and learn from some of the top academics in the field. You can explore our incredible range of courses online.

Whatever you choose to do, please stay in touch. We'd love to hear about your achievements and discover where your Essex degree has taken you. In the Department of Psychology we offer the following courses:

- MSc Psychology
- MSc Cognitive Neuroscience and Neuropsychology
- MSc Research Methods in Psychology
- MSD Psychology (Masters by Dissertation)
- PhD

Find out more on our [postgraduate](#) and [Course Finder](#) webpages.

Academic career advice

Are you thinking of pursuing a career in academia, or would you like more information about this kind of career?. Speak to your year tutor or project supervisor. They will be more than happy to answer your questions and give you advice.

Do you find yourself excited to learn about psychology research? Do you enjoy reading research articles and find yourself eager to know about the results of a study? Do you enjoy statistics (even if you are sometimes intimidated or find it difficult)? In general, are you passionate about finding out first-hand the factors that shape human behaviour and cognition? If so, you may want to consider an academic career!

A career in academia allows you to teach and do research in the area of psychology that you love alongside other colleagues who are just as passionate as you. An environment that is stimulating, challenging and exciting coupled with following one's passions can lead to a long and rewarding career. To get started, check out the following road map (and keep in mind there are many, many sub-goals for each step, so don't get overwhelmed!):

Step 1: Is an academic career right for me?

A first step is to gain as much experience as you can with psychology research. Students are encouraged to attend as many research seminars and read as many primary research articles as you can to get a feel of your favourite areas. Can you see yourself doing this kind of research as well? You should also gain experience by becoming active in doing research. The department's Research Experience Scheme

(RES), Undergraduate Research Opportunities Programme (UROP) and Frontrunners all allow students to gain knowledge and experience of doing research while being guided by a supervisor on a variety of different topics in psychology. These experiences will help you determine if you feel really committed to an academic career as well as make your application for graduate study even more competitive.

Step 2: Graduate study

You will need to do graduate study for an academic career. You may choose to do a Masters before a PhD or go straight to a PhD program. There are different methods to accomplish this:

- Apply for PhD positions that are advertised online on academic job websites, such as [Jobs.ac.uk](https://jobs.ac.uk)
- Independently identify a supervisor who is enthusiastic to support your PhD studies and develop a project together

Whereas funding often accompanies the former method, applications for funding are often required for the second method via Research Council competitions.

Step 3: After Graduate study

Post-doctoral positions are often required for continuing on in academia. Similar to the PhD, the two main methods of securing a position are to:

- Apply for a post-doc position advertised online on academic job websites
- Independently apply for fellowship funding after having identified a supervisor who is happy to have you join their team

If you would like to acquire a first experience of research, or to develop your research skills further, there are many research schemes (paid and unpaid) for which you might like to apply.

- [Research Experience Scheme \(RES\)](#)